

Tech shopping

The screenshot shows the eBay.in homepage. At the top, there's a search bar and navigation links like 'Sign in or register'. Below that, a 'Hot Picks' banner lists various electronics. A 'You require an additional password to use your credit card online' message is visible. The main section features 'Bestsellers' with images of products like Sony, DVD, HDD, BlackBerry, Nokia, Apple iPhone, iPod Classic, iPod Shuffle, iPod Nano, Olympus, Nikon, Canon, Ericsson, Samsung, HTC, iPod Touch, MP4 Players, MP3 Players, TFT, Webcams, Printers, LCD TVs, Cordless, DVD Players, Sony PS2, Sony PS3, Nintendo Wii, Laptop, Hard Drives, Pen Drives, Bluetooth, Headphones, Photo Frames, Sony PSP, Xbox 360, and Games. There are also banners for 'Designer Jewellery', 'LCD MELA', and 'Deals of the week!'. The bottom section lists 'eBay Categories' including Apparel & Accessories, Fun Stuff, Services & Real Estate, Books & Magazines, Health & Beauty, Stamps, and Cameras & Optics, Home, Decor & Furnishings, Tools & Hardware.



for people who want to build computers. The IT Depot is somewhat like a **Newegg.com** for Indian customers. You can pretty much buy anything you need to build a computer from this single store. They claim to ship to pretty much any location in the country.

The range of products available on the site is also pretty vast, which makes it even more ideal for those not in the vicinity of major cities. Products can be sorted by category and price range. There are also electronics that can be bought here. Cameras, DVD players, software and even Apple products can be purchased. The pricing isn't very reliable though. In some cases, the pricing is almost identical to market price but in some others, they can

When we talk about tech shopping, we're not limiting ourselves to just computer hardware, but we're looking for a web site that provides us with an overall solution for all kind of products, such as cell phones, digital cameras, and also computer hardware such as power supplies and graphic cards. The search and categorisation features on the web sites were important criteria, along

Special mention

Here's an interesting site to visit – www.naaptol.com. When you either search or browse through products here, you will be given a store list and redirected to where the product is actually available. This service is helpful in a way that you don't need to go scouting to all the web sites to look for the particular product. Most of product searches came back with relevant results and this site also has good filtering options.

search results had many options too, and it doesn't get too hard to find the product you are looking for.

As most of you already know, not only can you purchase products from Ebay, but you can also sell products, either new or opened. When it comes to selling

new products, **Ebay.in** also allows users to create stores. These stores are also used by companies, so **Ebay.in** allows them to have

Custom Gifting

So we now know where to buy tech products, but what about shopping for other items online? We're talking about custom gifts here, where you can customise products such as T-shirts, mugs, mousepads, and lighters and gift them to your friends and family. Though you could just buy them for yourself too. www.myntra.com is a custom gifts site that has a whole lot of categories of gifts that you can customise other than just t-shirts or mugs. They even have a category for custom mouse pads. Tshirts.in, formerly known as Xtees.com, is a similar site, but has a bigger range of premade t-shirts that you could opt for.

The last web site that deserves a mention here is www.inkfruit.com. Even though the number of categories is only limited to four – posters, t-shirts, hoodies and mugs, the community that this web site has created is really worth a mention. Not only can you create custom t-shirts, but you can also put forth your design in a regular contest and win prizes. This contest takes place quite often and the winners design becomes a part of the shop as well.



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with ease of navigation to these pages.

Most of the web sites that we looked at had at least one important search feature not working up to the mark and did not return us relevant results.

After browsing through many of our search criteria, **Ebay.in** impressed us the most and is the winner for the Digit Web Awards for the Tech Shopping category. One of the main factors **Ebay.in** wins is the number of available products on the web site. We got a huge number of hits for our product searches. Also, the categorisation of products was done very well. Filtering

a virtual store to sell their products as well. Images of the product and descriptions are also present, plus the feedback from people who have already purchased products from the same seller or store.

Though the number of products on sale is pretty large, this also creates a problem for users, as the products are repeated, until the search is correctly filtered out.

For those who want computer peripherals

The IT Depot (www.theitdepot.com) has a collection of products that is better suited

be heavily bloated.

One of the smaller hardware sites is **TheiTWares** (www.theitwares.com). It's a shop based in Mumbai, also willing to ship computer hardware to any place outside Mumbai. It's a crude system but being a computer store, pricing is good. They're also willing to assemble your system for you for a fee.

Another such store in Mumbai is **PrimeABGB** (www.primeabgb.com). The prices on the site are inflated but a quick phone call to their office can get you reasonable prices. One of the biggest advantages is the choice of products. A lot of brands and products that aren't available easily can be found on this site. **d**